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Graduate Recruitment Team

Jane Street

2½ Devonshire Square

London EC2M 4UJ

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Quantitative Trader (Full-Time, New Graduate) role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Jane Street's view that how you think matters more than what you already know is why I am applying as an economist rather than a mathematician.

Most of what I am proudest of comes down to good decisions made with incomplete information. Playing 12 poker tables at once, I based every decision on expected value and set my stakes with the Kelly criterion, keeping at least 50 buy-ins because an edge estimated from my own results could be overstated. I also finished 14th at the Irish U19 Chess Championships in 2023 and won 21 of 22 games in a simultaneous exhibition against players with an average FIDE rating of 1860. As Vice-President and then President of the Strathclyde Poker Society, I ran weekly tournaments for around 60 players on a £600 budget per semester and taught new members to use the same method to work out how many buy-ins their own win rate, variance and risk tolerance call for.

I pair that instinct with quantitative work I can defend line by line. I built a Monte Carlo option pricer in which a geometric-Asian control variate cut the standard error of arithmetic-Asian estimates by 97% at 100,000 paths, and my dissertation tests whether sovereign oil hedges make petro-currencies' oil betas smaller, kinked or one-sided on OPEC announcement days, with a pre-registered test of whether what remains is tradable. Proprietary trading appeals to me because the feedback is immediate and impartial: every decision is priced, and improving means learning faster than the market. Nearly two years of busy bar shifts alongside full-time study, and now running the drinks programme as Head Mixologist at a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, have taught me to stay accurate when speed matters.

Jane Street stands out to me because it gives new traders significant responsibility within weeks to months, backed by a year-long firmwide curriculum, and because its London presence is growing, with an offer placed on a new office that would double its footprint. I would bring the habit my own research has taught me, testing whether an apparent edge survives costs; my wheat spread's Sharpe ratio fell from 0.76 to 0.28 once I did.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan